

Zhen Ding Technology Holding (4958.TW)

Pricing hike to drive profitability for IC substrate business in 2026; Buy

4958.TW

12m Price Target: **NT\$228.00**Price: **NT\$171.50**Upside: **32.9%**

ZDT held its 4Q25 results call on Mar 12th. Key takeaways from management include:

(1) The company expect its IC substrate (including ABF and BT substrate) business to see solid growth in 2026 with demand driven by substrate upgrade trend. With more advanced ABF specification under qualification (28 layers/158 x 158 mm size vs. normal AI IC substrate spec of 14-18 layers/60-75 x 60-75mm), which we believe is for CSP's ASIC projects, management also mentioned ABF business will turn profitable this year.

(2) For BT substrate, ZDT mentioned UTR continues to stay at a high level with orders in Jan+Feb for BT substrate reaching historical level, which we believe is driven by high memory demand. The company will continue debottlenecking the Qinghuangdao plant, which will increase its capacity in this year.

(3) The company have implemented price adjustment for both old and new products for different product lines due to the shortage in raw material (including low to high end glass, gold, copper, etc), and sees more flexibility to further raise price if demand and supply condition continues to mismatch.

(4) ZDT expect AI servers and ASIC will continue to drive demand for HDI & multi-layer PCB, with growth to accelerate in 2H26. For high layer PCB, the company has entered mass production for 20-30 layers PCB (for mainstream AI PCB), with 30-50 layers PCB (for next gen AI PCB) in NPI, and is developing toward 70-80 layers PCB (which we believe is for future high-end products, such as backplane, CoWoP, etc).

(5) The demand for FPC is increasing, driven by energy storage (multiple-fold growth), AI glasses (double digit growth) and new foldable phones. Per ZDT, the key smartphone customer is expecting to release foldable phone this year, and we expect it to

BUY

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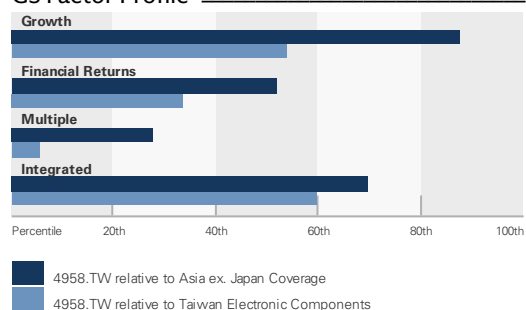
Key Data

Market cap: NT\$168.4bn / \$5.3bn
Enterprise value: NT\$205.8bn / \$6.5bn
3m ADTV: NT\$4.0bn / \$125.3mn
Taiwan
Taiwan Electronic Components
M&A Rank: 3
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes

GS Forecast

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Revenue (NT\$ mn) New	182,521.6	220,615.6	277,305.8	345,114.2
Revenue (NT\$ mn) Old	183,402.5	220,131.9	270,400.3	—
EBITDA (NT\$ mn)	34,259.5	45,461.3	60,541.4	75,354.7
EPS (NT\$) New	6.91	14.04	21.67	29.01
EPS (NT\$) Old	7.50	14.69	21.58	—
P/E (X)	18.6	12.2	7.9	5.9
P/B (X)	0.8	1.0	0.9	0.8
Dividend yield (%)	2.7	4.1	6.3	8.5
CROCI (%)	12.8	15.5	17.2	18.2
	12/25	3/26E	6/26E	9/26E
EPS (NT\$)	3.16	1.03	1.47	4.86

GS Factor Profile



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.
See disclosures for details.

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BUY

**Zhen Ding Technology Holding
(4958.TW)**

Rating since Apr 29, 2025

Ratios & Valuation

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
P/E (X)	18.6	12.2	7.9	5.9
P/B (X)	0.8	1.0	0.9	0.8
FCF yield (%)	6.0	(4.3)	(1.3)	3.6
EV/EBITDAR (X)	4.2	4.6	3.8	3.2
EV/EBITDA (excl. leases) (X)	4.2	4.6	3.7	3.2
CROCI (%)	12.8	15.5	17.2	18.2
ROE (%)	6.1	12.1	17.4	21.1
Net debt/equity (%)	(17.9)	(9.0)	(2.9)	(1.6)
Net debt/equity (excl. leases) (%)	(18.6)	(9.7)	(3.4)	(2.1)
Interest cover (X)	5.9	9.3	14.7	19.9
Days inventory outst, sales	35.2	30.7	29.2	28.9
Receivable days	62.6	57.3	55.4	54.8
Days payable outstanding	54.1	51.9	52.5	52.6
DuPont ROE (%)	4.3	8.2	11.3	13.3
Turnover (X)	0.7	0.7	0.9	1.0
Leverage (X)	1.7	1.7	1.7	1.7
Gross cash invested (ex cash) (NT\$)	245,050.5	294,256.6	349,629.7	406,276.7
Average capital employed (NT\$)	128,889.6	142,495.5	170,354.0	199,545.0
BVPS (NT\$)	162.13	172.01	191.79	218.27

Growth & Margins (%)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Total revenue growth	6.3	20.9	25.7	24.5
EBITDA growth	16.8	32.7	33.2	24.5
EPS growth	(28.5)	103.0	54.4	33.9
DPS growth	(28.0)	103.0	54.4	33.9
EBIT margin	7.6	10.0	12.6	13.7
EBITDA margin	18.8	20.6	21.8	21.8
Net income margin	3.7	6.4	7.8	8.4

Price Performance

Source: FactSet. Price as of 12 Mar 2026 close.

Income Statement (NT\$ mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Total revenue	182,521.6	220,615.6	277,305.8	345,114.2
Cost of goods sold	(146,385.2)	(172,774.5)	(213,003.0)	(261,307.5)
SG&A	(10,392.9)	(12,273.0)	(13,638.2)	(16,977.3)
R&D	(11,811.9)	(13,400.9)	(15,691.4)	(19,544.4)
Other operating inc./exp.)	—	—	—	—
EBITDA	34,259.5	45,461.3	60,541.4	75,354.7
Depreciation & amortization	(20,327.9)	(23,294.2)	(25,568.2)	(28,069.8)
EBIT	13,931.6	22,167.2	34,973.1	47,285.0
Net interest inc./exp.)	1,372.5	1,651.3	1,034.6	562.2
Income/(loss) from associates	—	—	—	—
Pre-tax profit	14,062.7	23,467.2	36,273.1	48,585.0
Provision for taxes	(3,457.6)	(3,605.0)	(5,643.1)	(7,578.9)
Minority interest	(3,814.6)	(5,820.7)	(8,956.0)	(11,983.6)
Preferred dividends	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (pre-exceptionals)	6,790.5	14,041.5	21,674.1	29,022.5
Post-tax exceptionals	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (post-exceptionals)	6,790.5	14,041.5	21,674.1	29,022.5
EPS (basic, pre-exception) (NT\$)	6.91	14.04	21.67	29.01
EPS (diluted, pre-exception) (NT\$)	6.91	14.04	21.67	29.01
EPS (basic, post-exception) (NT\$)	6.91	14.04	21.67	29.01
EPS (diluted, post-exception) (NT\$)	6.91	14.04	21.67	29.01
DPS (NT\$)	3.46	7.02	10.83	14.51
Div. payout ratio (%)	50.0	50.0	50.0	50.0

Balance Sheet (NT\$ mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Cash & cash equivalents	85,412.0	72,341.4	62,329.5	60,247.2
Accounts receivable	31,643.0	37,642.8	46,555.8	56,994.4
Inventory	17,211.6	19,841.1	24,509.9	30,068.3
Other current assets	4,058.4	4,058.4	4,058.4	4,058.4
Total current assets	138,325.1	133,883.7	137,453.8	151,368.4
Net PP&E	110,897.8	138,156.9	165,141.8	189,625.2
Net intangibles	1,543.5	990.3	437.1	(116.1)
Total investments	6,834.1	6,834.1	6,834.1	6,834.1
Other long-term assets	14,381.3	14,381.3	14,381.3	14,381.3
Total assets	271,981.8	294,246.3	324,248.1	362,092.9
Accounts payable	21,657.0	27,454.6	33,847.1	41,522.8
Short-term debt	21,706.4	21,706.4	21,706.4	21,706.4
Short-term lease liabilities	246.9	246.9	246.9	246.9
Other current liabilities	24,372.6	27,998.1	31,814.4	35,488.6
Total current liabilities	67,982.9	77,406.0	87,614.8	98,964.8
Long-term debt	34,011.7	34,011.7	34,011.7	34,011.7
Long-term lease liabilities	872.6	872.6	872.6	872.6
Other long-term liabilities	9,881.2	9,881.2	9,881.2	9,881.2
Total long-term liabilities	44,765.4	44,765.4	44,765.4	44,765.4
Total liabilities	112,748.3	122,171.4	132,380.2	143,730.2
Preferred shares	—	—	—	—
Total common equity	112,213.5	119,234.2	130,071.3	144,582.5
Minority interest	47,020.0	52,840.6	61,796.6	73,780.2
Total liabilities & equity	271,981.8	294,246.3	324,248.1	362,092.9
Net debt, adjusted	(29,693.9)	(16,623.3)	(6,611.4)	(4,529.1)

Cash Flow (NT\$ mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Net income	6,790.5	14,041.5	21,674.1	29,022.5
D&A add-back	20,327.9	23,294.2	25,568.2	28,069.8
Minority interest add-back	3,814.6	5,820.7	8,956.0	11,983.6
Net (inc)/dec working capital	34.0	(2,831.6)	(7,189.4)	(8,321.1)
Other operating cash flow	—	—	—	—
Cash flow from operations	30,967.1	40,324.7	49,008.9	60,754.7
Capital expenditures	(20,500.0)	(50,000.0)	(52,000.0)	(52,000.0)
Acquisitions	—	—	—	—
Divestitures	—	—	—	—
Others	—	—	—	—
Cash flow from investing	(20,500.0)	(50,000.0)	(52,000.0)	(52,000.0)
Repayment of lease liabilities	—	—	—	—
Dividends paid (common & pref)	(4,557.1)	(3,395.3)	(7,020.8)	(10,837.0)
Inc/(dec) in debt	—	—	—	—
Other financing cash flows	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Cash flow from financing	(4,557.1)	(3,395.3)	(7,020.8)	(10,837.0)
Total cash flow	5,910.0	(13,070.6)	(10,011.9)	(2,082.3)
Free cash flow	10,467.1	(9,675.3)	(2,991.1)	8,754.7

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.

have 30-50% more FPC dollar content vs. standard smartphone due to the more complex design.

(6) For optical-related business, the company mentioned that orders are primarily driven by 800G/1.6T with order visibility remaining high, while some clients are already booking 2027 capacity.

(7) Management remains confident in its CAPEX plan, revised up from previous guidance of NT\$30bn to NT\$50bn+ in 2026, and is likely to sustain the similar level through 2027/28. This year's CAPEX is primarily for expanding HDI and higher layer count PCBs (~60% of CAPEX), with the remainder allocated between IC substrates and FPC. 10 factories across Huai'an, Thailand and Taiwan are under construction, in order to meet increasing clients demand.

ZDT 4Q25 core business (OPI) was 11%/4% lower than GSe/BBG consensus, while GM was slightly lower than GSe/consensus by 0.2/0.2ppt in 4Q25 mainly due to the negative impact from rising raw material cost and higher depreciation cost. The company spent NT\$6,909mn OPEX in 4Q25, which was higher than GSe/BBG consensus of NT\$6,295mn/NT\$6,247mn. For earnings, these were 13%/21% lower than GSe/BBG consensus.

Going into 1Q26, we expect ZDT revenue to go down by 23% QoQ, mainly due to the weakness in mobile communication business, reflecting typical seasonality. For GM, we expect ZDT's 1Q26 GM to further go down by 5.7ppt QoQ to 16.9%, after factor in the worsening product mix. Overall, we believe ZDT's 1Q26 EPS will go down to NT\$1.03 vs. NT\$3.16 in 4Q25, with weak smartphone seasonality despite the substrate demand outlook remaining strong.

Investment view

We remain positive on substrate business outlook, while ZDT's ABF capacity UTR is currently at 70-80% (vs. peer average of 74% in 4Q25) and the company expects to reach full UTR by 2H26. We believe the company will have the ability to increase ABF price under full UTR and strong demand, while the industry remains conservative with its capacity expansion plans over the next 1-2 years. The company mentioned price adjustments for its ABF products, which is in line with our view that ABF pricing will go up ~10% QoQ per quarter for the rest of 2026 and we expect ABF shortage could start from 2H26 (see [here](#)). The business condition for ABF substrate is good with price increase, and the company expect the business to turn profitable this year, which was loss making in 2025 (we estimate IC substrate business had a negative impact of more than NT\$1/share, which is around 14% of 2025 EPS).

We expect that the ABF capacity shortage will drive ZDT's market share considering the company's technology skillset, including (1) the CEO of the IC substrate business previously served as the CEO of Unimicron, one of the leading ABF substrate suppliers, with a technical background focused on ABF factory expansion, this experience is expected to drive the technology upgrade of ZDT's IC substrate business; (2) the company's ABF substrate factory features high level of automation; and (3) having world-class ABF equipment with continuous investment in advanced equipment.

AI server demand is likely to accelerate in 2H26. The company has passed verification for PCB supply in Vera Rubin's compute tray, and we expect the contribution to become

more meaningful in 2H26-1H27, with good profitability (average OPM of 20-30% for AI computing tray vs. company overall OPM of 10-15%), assuming the company continues to deliver good yield.

The company expect to expand 15 factories as a long term strategy, this is in line with our positive view of AI PCB to see 140% 2025-27E CAGR (see [here](#)), and we believe ZDT will be one of the winners in the AI era considering its good execution history and aggressive capacity expansion plan compared to peer companies.

Overall, we reiterate our Buy-rating on ZDT, with a new 12m TP of NT\$228 (from NT\$200).

Exhibit 1: ZDT's 4Q25 earnings comp table

ZDT (4958.TW)	4Q25			QoQ		YoY		Bloomberg consensus	
P&L (NT\$mnn)	Actual	GS est.	Diff. (%)	3Q25	QoQ	4Q24	YoY	Consensus	%
Revenue	56,870	57,750	-2%	47,366	20%	56,133	1%	51,731	10%
Gross profits	12,830	12,917	-1%	10,410	23%	11,471	12%	11,467	12%
Operating profits	5,921	6,622	-11%	4,530	31%	5,554	7%	6,022	-2%
Pre-tax income	5,673	6,622	-14%	4,661	22%	7,760	-27%	6,460	-12%
Net earnings	3,161	3,642	-13%	2,392	32%	4,363	-28%	3,968	-20%
EPS, NT\$	3.16	3.74	-16%	2.46	28%	4.60	-31%	3.92	-19%
Gross margin (%)	22.6%	22.4%	0.2ppt	22.0%	0.6ppt	20.4%	2.1ppt	22.2%	0.4ppt
EBIT margin (%)	10.4%	11.5%	-1.1ppt	9.6%	0.8ppt	9.9%	0.5ppt	11.6%	-1.2ppt
Net margin (%)	5.6%	6.3%	-0.7ppt	5.0%	0.5ppt	7.8%	-2.2ppt	7.7%	-2.1ppt

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Bloomberg

Earnings revisions

We revise down our 2026E net income estimate by 2% to factor in the higher raw material cost and revise up our 2027E net income by 3% to factor in higher AI-related contribution. We cut our 2026E GPM by 0.2ppt to reflect higher cost related to capacity ramp up and raise our 2027E GPM by 0.1ppt to factor in improved product mix.

In this report, we introduce our 2028 estimates.

Exhibit 2: Earnings revision table

ZD Tech P&L (NT\$ mn)	2025E New	2025E Old	Diff.	2026E New	2026E Old	Diff.	2027E New	2027E Old	Diff.	2028E New
Sales	182,522	183,402	0%	220,616	220,132	0%	277,306	270,400	3%	345,114
Gross Profit	36,136	36,223	0%	47,841	48,101	-1%	64,303	62,360	3%	83,807
EBIT	13,932	14,633	-5%	22,167	22,596	-2%	34,973	33,847	3%	47,285
Net Income	6,791	7,271	-7%	14,042	14,299	-2%	21,674	21,006	3%	29,023
EPS (NT\$)	6.91	7.50	-8%	14.04	14.69	-4%	21.67	21.58	0%	29.01
Ratio analysis										
Gross margin	19.8%	19.8%	0.0pp	21.7%	21.9%	-0.2pp	23.2%	23.1%	0.1pp	24.3%
EBIT margin	7.6%	8.0%	-0.3pp	10.0%	10.3%	-0.2pp	12.6%	12.5%	0.1pp	13.7%
Net margin	3.7%	4.0%	-0.2pp	6.4%	6.5%	-0.1pp	7.8%	7.8%	0.0pp	8.4%

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Valuation

We maintain our Buy-rating on ZDT with a new 12m TP of NT\$228 (from NT\$200), which is based on a SOTP-based valuation in 2H26-1H27E (from 2026; substrate value of NT\$53 per share, AI PCB is NT\$94 per share, while FPC is NT\$82 per share), with a breakdown by ABF substrate, high growth AI server PCB, and consumer electronics, and factoring in our earnings revisions.

Exhibit 3: P&L table

NT\$m	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26E	2Q26E	3Q26E	4Q26E	1Q27E	2Q27E	3Q27E	4Q27E	2024	2025E	2026E	2027E	2028E
Revenue	40,082	38,203	47,366	56,870	43,691	43,688	60,443	72,793	55,531	59,442	75,836	86,496	171,664	182,522	220,616	277,306	345,114
Gross profit	5,885	7,011	10,410	12,830	7,362	8,393	14,472	17,614	10,502	12,467	19,404	21,930	32,461	36,136	47,841	64,303	83,807
Operating expense	(4,829)	(4,586)	(5,880)	(6,909)	(5,724)	(5,985)	(6,467)	(7,498)	(6,108)	(6,955)	(7,963)	(8,304)	(20,875)	(22,205)	(25,674)	(29,330)	(36,522)
Operating income	1,056	2,425	4,530	5,921	1,638	2,408	8,005	10,116	4,394	5,512	11,441	13,626	11,586	13,932	22,167	34,973	47,285
Pretax income	1,457	2,272	4,661	5,673	1,738	2,508	8,105	11,116	4,494	5,612	11,541	14,626	15,045	14,063	23,467	36,273	48,585
Taxes expense	(431)	(885)	(1,072)	(1,070)	(296)	(426)	(1,216)	(1,667)	(764)	(954)	(1,731)	(2,194)	(1,948)	(3,458)	(3,605)	(5,643)	(7,579)
Net income	632	605	2,392	3,161	1,034	1,475	4,863	6,670	2,674	3,300	6,925	8,776	9,180	6,791	14,042	21,674	29,023
EPS, NT\$	0.66	0.63	2.46	3.16	1.03	1.47	4.86	6.67	2.67	3.30	6.92	8.77	9.67	6.91	14.04	21.67	29.01
Ratio analysis and assumption																	
As % of sales																	
Gross margin	14.7%	18.4%	22.0%	22.6%	16.9%	19.2%	23.9%	24.2%	18.9%	21.0%	25.6%	25.4%	18.9%	19.8%	21.7%	23.2%	24.3%
Operating expense ratio	12.0%	12.0%	12.4%	12.1%	13.1%	13.7%	10.7%	10.3%	11.0%	11.7%	10.5%	9.6%	12.2%	12.2%	11.6%	10.6%	10.6%
Operating margin	2.6%	6.3%	9.6%	10.4%	3.8%	5.5%	13.2%	13.9%	7.9%	9.3%	15.1%	15.8%	6.7%	7.6%	10.0%	12.6%	13.7%
Net margin	1.6%	1.6%	5.0%	5.6%	2.4%	3.4%	8.0%	9.2%	4.8%	5.6%	9.1%	10.1%	5.3%	3.7%	6.4%	7.8%	8.4%
QoQ growth (%)																	
Revenue	-28.6%	-4.7%	24.0%	20.1%	-23.2%	0.0%	38.4%	20.4%	-23.7%	7.0%	27.6%	14.1%	-	-	-	-	-
Gross profit	-48.7%	19.1%	48.5%	23.2%	-42.6%	14.0%	72.4%	21.7%	-40.4%	18.7%	55.6%	13.0%	-	-	-	-	-
Operating income	-81.0%	129.6%	86.8%	30.7%	-72.3%	47.0%	232.5%	26.4%	-56.6%	25.5%	107.6%	19.1%	-	-	-	-	-
Net income	-85.5%	-4.3%	295.3%	32.2%	-67.3%	42.6%	229.8%	37.2%	-59.9%	23.4%	109.8%	26.7%	-	-	-	-	-
YoY growth (%)																	
Revenue	23.3%	17.9%	-6.4%	1.3%	9.0%	14.4%	27.6%	28.0%	27.1%	36.1%	25.5%	18.8%	13%	6%	21%	26%	24%
Gross profit	10.3%	65.1%	-8.7%	11.9%	25.1%	19.7%	39.0%	37.3%	42.7%	48.5%	34.1%	24.5%	18%	11%	32%	34%	30%
Operating income	42.2%	-476.8%	-23.6%	6.6%	55.2%	-0.7%	76.7%	70.9%	168.2%	128.9%	42.9%	34.7%	26%	20%	59%	58%	35%
Net income	-35.3%	24.5%	-28.7%	-27.5%	63.5%	143.7%	103.3%	111.0%	158.5%	123.8%	42.4%	31.6%	48%	-26%	107%	54%	34%

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Zhen Ding Technology (ZDT) is the global leading PCB supplier (top 1 in market share in sales) with 7-10% market share, and started its ABF substrate business from 2023 in Shenzhen, China, and has the highest ABF revenue exposure to the China market compared to all other ABF substrate suppliers. We believe ZDT will hold more than 40% ABF substrate market share in China by 2027E (up from 31% in 2024) and benefit the most from the strong and growing China ABF substrate market (53% 2025E-27E CAGR) due to the increasing in-sourcing ratio for the AI computing ASIC/GPU market in China. We also expect the increasing foldable smartphone penetration rate in the long term to drive ZDT's FPC TAM, and account for 55%+ of the company's total revenue in 2027E. We see further revenue upside potential from foldable phones. We are Buy rated mainly due to our positive view on the company's China ABF substrate business opportunity, which should not only drive ZDT's revenue growth, but also improve its OPM level in the long term. We see upside for the stock price considering the company's solid growth opportunity, and our TP implied P/E multiple is still lower than the company's past 10+ year P/E average, which we believe is fair considering the potential upside from China ABF substrate market and increasing foldable phone penetration rate.

Valuation: Our 12-month TP of NT\$228 is based on a SOTP valuation methodology, including (1) 2.6x blended 2H26-1H27E P/B for ABF & BT substrate, (2) 20x 2H26-1H27E P/E for high-growth AI server/switch related PCB (in line with industry average), and (3) 8x 2H26-1H27E P/E for low-growth consumer electronics PCB (in-line with industry downcycle average valuation).

Key downside risks include: (1) weaker-than-expected iPhone demand or slower content upgrade, (2) delay in new substrate capacity or slower-than-expected yield rate ramp up progress, and (3) fiercer competition in China ABF market.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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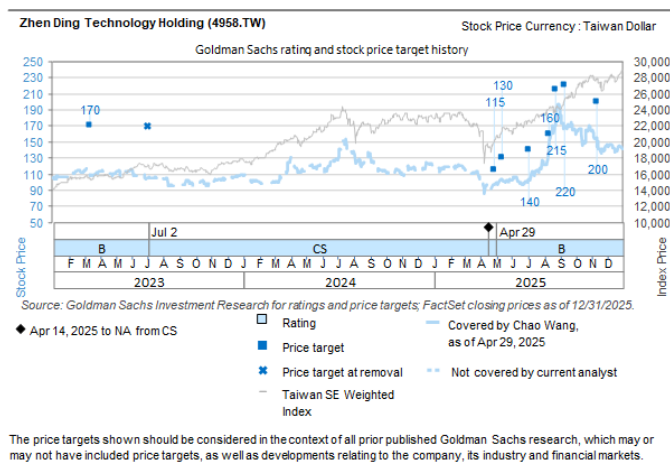
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